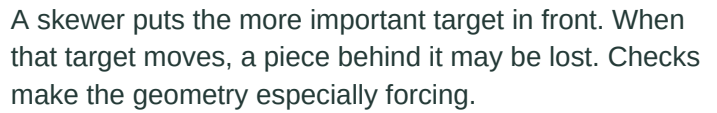


## Skewers

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on d3. Geometrically undefended: queen on g3. Check for tactical protection.

Previous move: 53...Qg3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

54. Qa3+ Kd2 55. Qxg3

**54.Qa3+** Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **54...Kd2**.

**55.Qxg3** The queen captures the queen on g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using  $P=1$ ,  $N/B=3$ ,  $R=5$ ,  $Q=9$ , how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from +0 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.